BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #29 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

“It's in my genes, so there's no point trying.”

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Where it often comes from

When a condition has a genetic component, some conclude that effort, treatment, and habits are pointless. This fatalism can keep people from the very steps that help.

What Scripture teaches

“Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.” “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed.” God invites us to be wise stewards of the bodies and minds He gave. Genes load the dice but do not decide every roll. Diet, sleep, exercise, therapy, medication, and relationships often change outcomes significantly. “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

> *“Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up”* (Galatians 6:9).

Also see

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

> “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

> “Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast and immovable. Always excel in the work of the Lord, because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain” (1 Corinthians 15:58).

> “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes, but a wise man listens to counsel” (Proverbs 12:15).

Common self-statements

- Nothing I do will make a difference.
- Genes decide everything.
- Effort is wasted.
- I may as well give up.
- Why bother with treatment?
- I cannot change my biology.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing outcomes are either all genes or all effort.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that effort will fail.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling helpless and concluding that effort is useless.
- Labeling: Calling myself a victim of my genes.

Challenging questions

- What does my doctor say about what can be done?
- What lifestyle or treatment steps help even with a genetic risk?
- Do I know people who managed well despite genetics?
- What would trying look like in a small way?

- What does Scripture say about not giving up?
- Who can help me stay motivated?

Truth summary

> Genes are one factor, not the whole story. Wise effort, good care, and God's help matter. I can take small steps and not give up.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Laziness
- Faith
- Wisdom
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "It's in my genes, so there's no point trying"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"It's in my genes, so there's no point trying." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does my doctor say about what can be done?
- ☐ What lifestyle or treatment steps help even with a genetic risk?
- ☐ Do I know people who managed well despite genetics?
- ☐ What would trying look like in a small way?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about not giving up?
- ☐ Who can help me stay motivated?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Effort is not wasted.
- ☐ I will not grow weary.
- ☐ Many advisers help.
- ☐ I can do all things through Christ.
- ☐ Small steps count.
- ☐ God works with my effort.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:9
  "Let us not grow weary in well-doing, for in due time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up."
- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."
- ☐ Philippians 4:13
  "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Doing what I can: Each week, note one helpful step you took.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:9 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Ask your doctor. Learn what helps for your condition.
- [ ] Pick one habit. Sleep, movement, or nutrition.
- [ ] Track progress. Write what changes.
- [ ] Pray Galatians 6:9. Ask for perseverance.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "It's in my genes, so there's no point trying": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Doing what I can
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~It's in my genes, so there's no point trying.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel that nothing matters. Give me wisdom to do what I can, strength to keep going, and trust that You work in my effort. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.